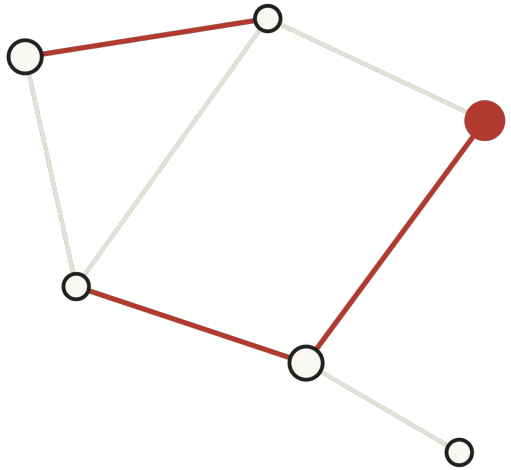
The Importance of Packet Analysis in AI-Assisted SOC

Last week's AI content doesn't make this skill less relevant, it makes it more valuable.



Dominic Yeakel | 9/23/2026

1 Verifying AI Claims

When an AI tool cites network activity as evidence for a verdict, packet analysis is often exactly how an analyst confirms that citation directly.

The core habit

This is the Day 3 verification habit, applied to its most concrete form of evidence.



2 A Skill AI Cannot Fully Replace

Interpreting an unusual traffic pattern in context still depends heavily on human judgment and experience.

What AI can do

Assist with summarization of what it sees.

What stays human

The underlying technical read remains an analyst skill.

3 Building Toward Data Analytics



The pattern recognition practiced here, spotting deviations from a baseline, is the same underlying skill used later this week when building SOC dashboards.

Packet Analysis

Baseline deviation, packet by packet.

→

Data Analytics

Baseline deviation, dashboard-wide.

Packet analysis and data analytics are more connected than they might first appear.



THE TAKEAWAY

AI changes how a SOC works. It doesn't change what makes an analyst worth trusting.